

The Watch

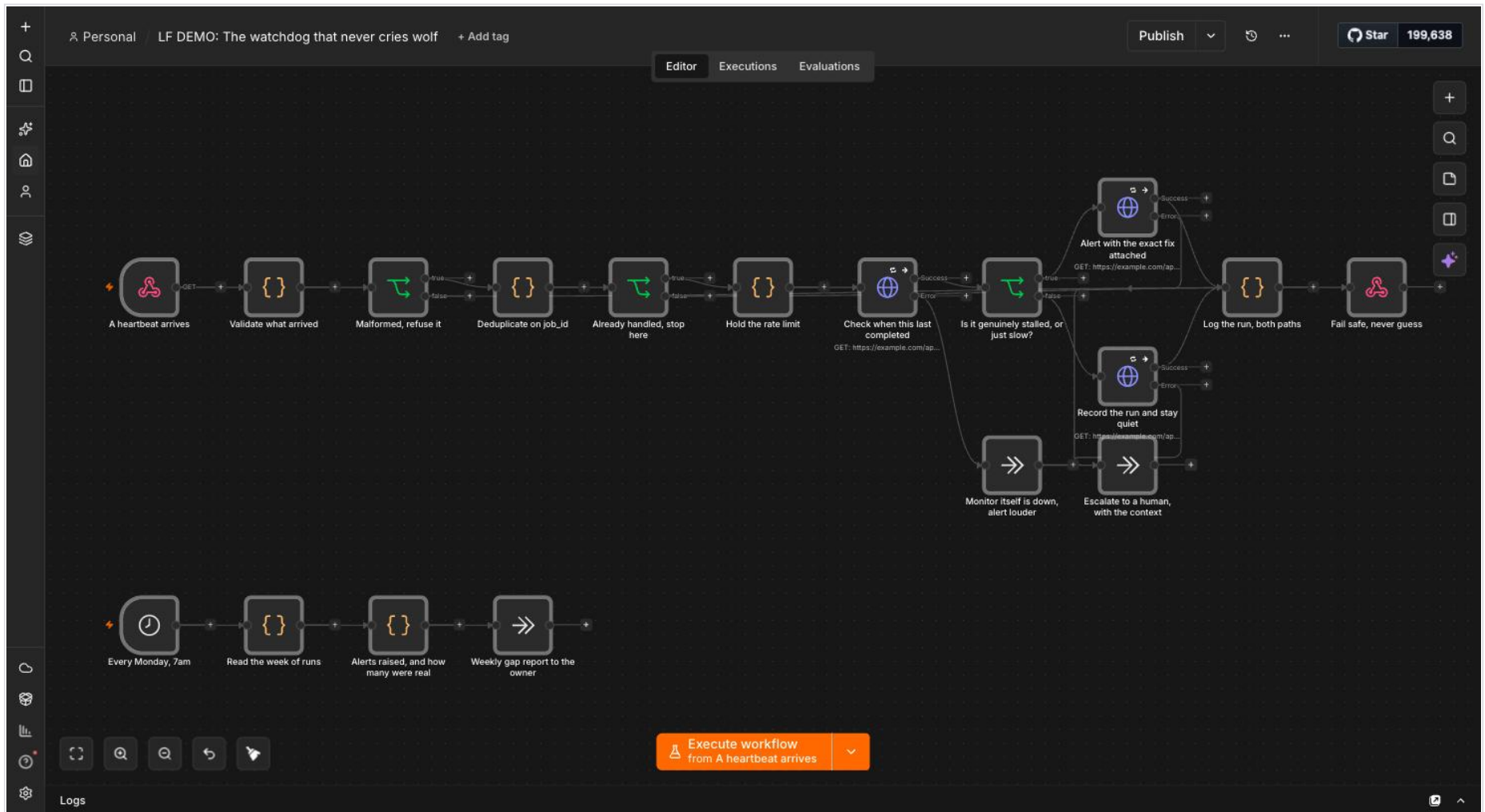
alerting · built in airtable

Something breaks silently and the business hears it from a customer. That's the most expensive way to find out.

What it connects to: The thing that breaks and the thing that tells you are never the same system, and the watchdog must not depend on the system it is watching.

1 of 4 SYSTEM

Here's the watchdog, with the exact fix carried inside the alert rather than just the symptom.



2 of 4 THINKING

It's tested against a planted failure before it ever watches anything real — an alert nobody trusts gets muted.

The screenshot shows a workflow editor interface for a node titled "Is it genuinely stalled, or just slow?". The interface is divided into three main sections: INPUT, Parameters, and OUTPUT.

INPUT Section: Displays "No input data" with a button "Execute previous nodes" and the text "to view input data".

Parameters Section: Contains tabs for "Parameters" and "Settings". Under "Parameters", there is a "Conditions" section with a JSON expression: `{{ $json.stalled === true && $json.minutesSince > $json.threshold }}`. A dropdown menu next to it shows "is true". Below the conditions is a toggle switch for "Convert types where required" which is currently turned off. There is also an "Options" section with a "+ Add option" button.

OUTPUT Section: Displays "No output data" with a button "Execute step" and the text "to view output data".

At the bottom of the Parameters section, there is a text input field with the placeholder "I wish this node would...".

The interface includes a sidebar on the left with various icons and a top bar with a "Docs" link and a close button.

3 of 4 THEIR-WORLD

The alerting path in the CRM, escalating with context.

SAMPLE - Cleaner Performance System

DataAutomationsInterfacesForms

All changes savedLaunchShare

AutomationsOFF1 - New complaint routes to re...HistoryTest automation

Create new...Find an automation

1 - New complaint routes to review queue
When a record is created, update a recordOFF

TRIGGER

When a record is created
In Incidents

ACTIONS

If Type is Complaint
Update a record

Update record
Excused?

Add condition

PropertiesDescription

Enter a description

CONFIGURATIONAction will run...
If Type is Complaint

* Table
Incidents

* Record ID
ID of the record to update. To update a record from a previous step, use the + menu to choose the step and its Record ID. Must correspond to the selected table.
Airtable record ID

* Fields
Excused?
Unreviewed
Choose field

TEST STEP
Test this action to confirm its configuration is correct. The data from this test can be used in later steps.
Generate a previewRun as configured
Generate a preview

4 of 4 MORE

And the precision check: how many alerts were actually real.

